

“I do,” Bill said. “We both do. I don’t know what we would have done if it weren’t for your help. I really was beginning to feel the pressure.”

“I haven’t done anything but help you realize that there’s an answer to your problems. Now it’s up to you to work out the details and stick to them. I’ll give you some materials that will help you understand the basic principles from God’s Word. These must be your guide if you want to make good decisions in the future. You need to learn how to keep your accounts accurately and keep up with your monthly budget. We’ll work that out together over the next few weeks.”

Bill and Andrea called the vice president of the bank in charge of credit card accounts and asked for a meeting the next day. They told him exactly what had happened and asked if there were a way they could work out a repayment plan. He agreed to convert the credit card debt into a personal loan, collateralized by both of their cars. The next month Bill’s car was sold, and they were able to pay the money they received toward the loan amount.

Andrea sold the stereo and television and used that money to pay on the loan. Within a few weeks they had the loan amount down to less than \$2,600. They worked out a repayment plan with the gas company with the help of Mike McKenna, so they could pay the minimum amount until the bank loan was repaid. The cash from the insurance policy reduced the loan by another \$780.

Bill took a job with a national delivery service that paid nearly twice what he had been making. Andrea took a job in telephone sales and found that she really enjoyed the work. Between the two of them, they were able to pay off the bank loan in five months, although it meant a lot of scrimping and early mornings as Bill would drop Andrea off at her job and then drive across town to his. But after three months, Bill’s employer allowed him to drive the company delivery van home in the evenings. That not only provided them a second vehicle, nearly cost-free, but also lowered their gas bill considerably.